

Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 8, 2026 | Version 4

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary (v20).

June 8, 2026 — What Is New:

- Thinking-state expression session done in ScoutFaceView.
- Iris no longer freezes while thinking — gentle drift instead.
- Iris jumping calmed during thinking.
- Eyes narrow (upper + lower lids) while thinking — focused look.
- Asymmetric thinking brows — one lifts, one stays low.
- Inner brow knit didn't read on-device — parked for a future pass.

1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
- Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
- Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9, Scout's biggest fan) | Dog: Nicolas
- Names must NEVER be hardcoded in Scout's code. Always use variables.
- Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review between them is welcome.

2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone mounted in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Scout has animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, and remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
- Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 (stress-test, not the benchmark)
- Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi)
- App: \$9.99 one-time purchase on Google Play. No subscriptions. Ever.
- Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, always included) + user's own free Gemini key (online, optional)

3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy

4. What Is Working Right Now

- ✓ Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — custom Canvas animation
- ✓ Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
- ✓ Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
- ✓ Gemini API integration (online brain, user's own key)
- ✓ Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
- ✓ Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY
- ✓ TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on BOTH A32 and Fold 7
- ✓ TinyLlama crash on A32 stabilized (June 7)
- ✓ Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
- ✓ Identity questions hardcoded (June 5); routing expanded (June 7)
- ✓ Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features (June 5)
- ✓ Thinking-state expression — drift, narrowed lids, asymmetric brows (NEW June 8)

5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

- Iris jitter (A32 idle) — hardware timing, separate from thinking drift (now fixed). Fold 7 smooth.
- Inner brow knit — downward inner tilt while thinking didn't read on-device. Parked.
- STT name recognition — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. STT/phonetic issue. Separate session.
- Live news — neither Gemini nor TinyLlama reads live news. Offline returns old frozen news. Future news feed needed.
- Barge-in — deliberately disabled. PARKED. Do not reactivate without a full dedicated session.

Current Priority — Update As Goals Shift

1. Inner brow knit while thinking (revisit) + wire in full mood system
2. Creator memory — implement CREATOR fact slot in TruthDb (NEXT MAJOR TASK)
3. STT phonetic matching for wake word 'Scout' — separate session
4. Downloads should respect 'go offline' (finish total-offline mode)
5. Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter (safety + identity + honest news handling)
6. Scout news feed — FUTURE feature, same clean pattern as weather
7. MainActivity cleanup and shortening — ongoing
8. Offline Brain Phase 3 — Google Play Asset Delivery

6. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
- Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits for large files — always specify which file tab to click first.
- Some Scout files have NO indentation (flush-left). If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
- Some logic lives in TWO places (updateLife AND scheduleNextFrame) — change both so they match, or Scout flickers.
- One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
- Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
- Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
- Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.

This Quick Start is the session-opener. For full architecture, NDK discoveries, business decisions, and technical reference — upload the Scout Master Summary (v20).

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